Document 15 — UAE (GCGRA) Technical Standards and Certification Plan

Operator	[COMPANY NAME], trading as PlayStake
Owner	[COMPLIANCE LEAD NAME], Head of Compliance, with [ENGINEERING LEAD NAME]
Version	0.1 — planning draft
Review	Before any UAE engagement; on any GCGRA publication
Relates to	UAE General Commercial Gaming Regulatory Authority (GCGRA) requirements; GLI standards series; Documents 11, 12, 13

> **Planning draft, not verified against primary sources.** The GCGRA website could not be accessed when this was prepared. Everything below about GCGRA requirements, licence categories, approved standards and approved laboratories comes from public secondary reporting and must be confirmed directly with the GCGRA and UAE legal counsel before any decision is taken. Gambling is otherwise prohibited in the UAE; nothing may be offered to UAE residents until PlayStake (or a partner) is licensed by the GCGRA.

1. Purpose

To set out what PlayStake would need to do to have its gambling system assessed and certified for the UAE market, reusing as much as possible of the UK work in Documents 11–13.

2. What we understand today (to confirm)

Topic	Current understanding	Source status
Regulator	GCGRA, a federal authority set up in 2023 to license and regulate commercial gaming in the UAE	Secondary reporting
Online gambling	The GCGRA licenses internet gaming and sports wagering; the first such licence was reported in November 2025 (Play 971)	Secondary reporting
Peer-to-peer skill wagering	**Unknown** whether a licence category exists for a platform like PlayStake, or whether it must operate through, or supply, an existing licensee	To ask GCGRA
Technical standards	GCGRA technical standards are reported to be based on the GLI standards series, in particular **GLI-19** (Interactive Gaming Systems) and **GLI-33** (Event Wagering Systems), with GCGRA-specific requirements on top	Secondary reporting
Independent test laboratories	Reported as Gaming Laboratories International (GLI) and BMM Testlabs (BMM North America and BMM Spain)	Secondary reporting

Topic	Current understanding	Source status
Data location, currency, identity	Not yet known. Likely requirements to check: hosting or data residency in the UAE, AED accounts, UAE identity verification (e.g. Emirates ID / UAE Pass), UAE-only geolocation	To ask GCGRA

3. Which standards are likely to apply

Standard	Why it may apply	Main areas it covers
GLI-19 Interactive Gaming Systems	PlayStake is an online platform with player accounts and a wallet	Player account management, KYC and geolocation, wallet and financial transactions, responsible gaming tools, interrupted matches, logging and reporting, security and change management. Its game fairness and RNG sections are unlikely to apply: PlayStake has run no games of its own since 25 October 2026 [CONFIRM with advisor]
GLI-33 Event Wagering Systems	Stream matches are wagers on the outcome of an external event (a live game), settled on a referee's result	Wager acceptance, event and result management, settlement, voids and cancellations
GCGRA-specific requirements	Local rules on responsible gaming, AML, data and reporting	[TO OBTAIN]

4. Plan

Phase	What	Output	Indicative timing
1. Confirm the route	Legal counsel in the UAE; formal enquiry to the GCGRA on whether and how peer-to-peer skill wagering can be licensed; whether PlayStake would apply itself or supply a licensee (B2B)	Written answer and chosen route	Month 1–2
2. Obtain the rules	Get the GCGRA technical standards, licensing rules and any lab-submission guidance; confirm which GLI standards and versions apply	Requirements library	Month 2
3. Gap assessment	Map each requirement to the platform, reusing the UK RTS statement (Document 12), testing strategy (Document 11) and ISO 27001 mapping (Document 13). Early candidates: UAE geolocation; UAE identity checks; AED currency; data residency; GCGRA reporting feeds; game recall display; any limits or tools the GCGRA mandates	Gap register with owners	Month 3
4. Build	Close the gaps as a UAE configuration of the same platform, behind jurisdiction settings, through the change control in Document 11 §5	Release candidate	Months 4–6

Phase	What	Output	Indicative timing
5. Lab engagement	Engage GLI or BMM (as approved by the GCGRA). Pre-submission meeting; submit source code, documentation and a test environment; platform (GLI-19 / GLI-33) testing	Lab report and certificate	Months 6–9
6. Licence submission	Submit certificates with the licence application or the partner's change notification	Approval	After phase 5
7. Ongoing	Re-certification for changes as the GCGRA requires; keep one change register covering UK and UAE; annual security audit covering both	Maintained certification	Continuous

5. What carries over from the UK work

- **Refereed results** (`src/lib/referees/`): referee independence checks, a hash-chained, append-only audit trail and a dispute window — relevant to GLI-33 result management and settlement. (PlayStake's own games and their RNG were withdrawn on 25 October 2026, so there is no game or RNG to certify.)
- **Double-entry ledger and per-bet escrow**, append-only, audited daily — the core of wallet and financial transaction requirements.
- **Safer gambling tools** (deposit limits, breaks, reality checks, interactions) and the single eligibility gate.
- **Security controls** mapped to ISO/IEC 27001:2022 (Document 13), and the incident process (Document 14).
- **Test evidence:** the automated test suite and any UK test-house or security audit reports. Ask the lab whether any UK work can be reused to shorten the UAE assessment.

6. Decisions and risks

Item	Note
Licence route	The biggest uncertainty; everything else depends on it
Data residency	If UAE hosting is required, PlayStake needs a second deployment in a UAE region, not just configuration. This changes Documents 08–10.
Choice of lab	Choosing the same lab for the UK and UAE (GLI or BMM are on both lists) may reduce cost and time

7. Next actions

1. Instruct UAE counsel and send the GCGRA enquiry. Owner: Head of Compliance.
2. Ask GLI and BMM for a scoping call covering both UK RTS testing and UAE certification. Owner: Head of Compliance.
3. Obtain the current GLI-19 and GLI-33 standards and start the gap register. Owner: Engineering.

Version	Date	Change
0.1	30 September 2026	First draft